

Pembrolizumab + carboplatin/paclitaxel → AC

Breast · NCCP 00857 · version 3

Your medicines

Pembrolizumab · Carboplatin · Paclitaxel · Doxorubicin · Cyclophosphamide

Your treatment schedule

Several treatment phases: weekly visits in the first phase, then 21-day cycles; see the full schedule overleaf.

A picture of side effects

Tell your team about new or worsening symptoms. The same symptom can have more than one cause. Numbers connect each symptom box to its location.

Pembrolizumab · immune effects

Chemotherapy · phase-specific effects

1 Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual fatigue, dizziness, headache or thirst should be reported.

2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

Report new cough or breathlessness promptly.

3 Heart

Doxorubicin / pembrolizumab

New chest symptoms, palpitations or breathlessness need assessment.

4 Liver / kidneys

Pembrolizumab

Blood tests monitor organ function. Report yellow eyes, dark urine or reduced urine.

5 Nerves

Paclitaxel

Report tingling or numbness before it persists or affects everyday activity.

6 Mouth / bowel

Chemotherapy / pembrolizumab

Report mouth soreness, persistent diarrhoea, vomiting or severe tummy pain.

7 Skin / nails

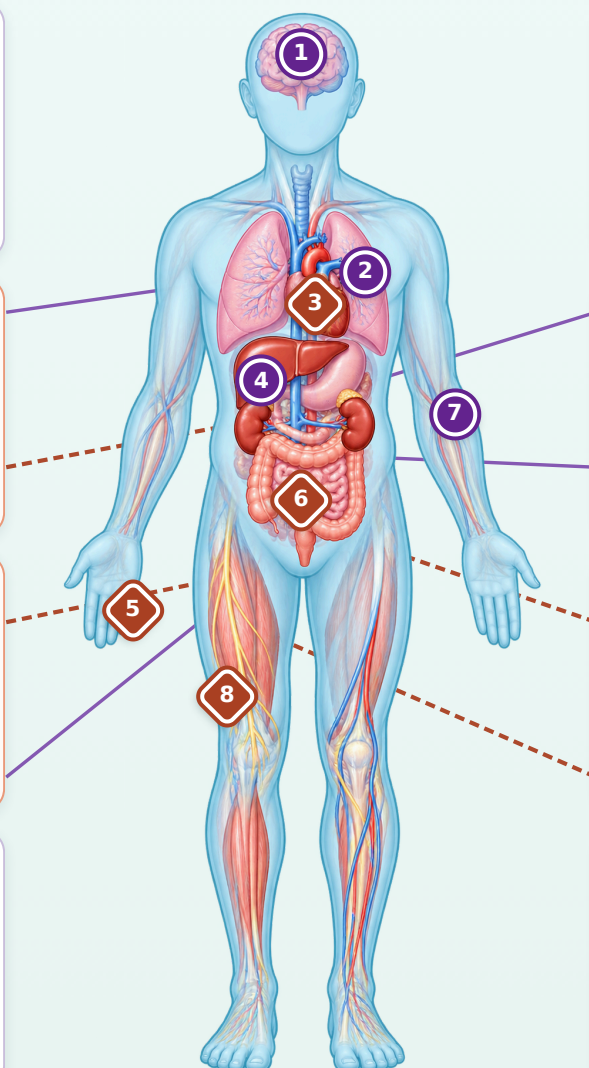
Chemotherapy / pembrolizumab

Rash, nail changes or an infusion reaction can occur. Severe or blistering rash needs urgent review.

8 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy

Fever or sudden illness needs immediate oncology contact. Medicines change between treatment phases.



This map shows selected effects to discuss; it does not show their likelihood or every possible side effect. Blood-count and whole-body effects are marked schematically.

Selected symptoms to help discussion. Tell your team about any new or worsening symptom. See page 2 for the schedule, support and QR.

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Your treatment journey

Cycles 1-4

Every 21 days: pembrolizumab + carboplatin on day 1; paclitaxel on days 1, 8 and 15.

Cycles 5-8

Every 21 days: pembrolizumab + doxorubicin + cyclophosphamide on day 1.

Surgery

Definitive breast surgery follows the neoadjuvant phase when clinically appropriate.

Adjuvant phase

Pembrolizumab continues after surgery: 200 mg every 21 days for 9 cycles or 400 mg every 42 days for 5 cycles, according to the treatment plan.

Throughout

Bloods and toxicity review guide whether treatment is given, delayed or modified.

Monitoring and support

- Blood count, kidney/liver profile and glucose are checked regularly; thyroid testing is repeated during pembrolizumab treatment.
- Paclitaxel requires premedication according to the regimen/local protocol.
- Cardiac assessment may be required before the doxorubicin phase.
- Your current medicines, including non-prescription products.
- A note of new symptoms, when they started and what they stopped you doing.
- Any temperature, blood-pressure or bowel-count readings your team asked you to record.
- Questions about the purpose of treatment, scan/review timing or changes to the plan.

05 / when to call Do not wait for the next appointment Use your oncology SOS instructions Call oncology urgently for fever, new breathlessness, persistent diarrhoea, jaundice, severe rash, significant bleeding, severe weakness or a new neurological symptom. For severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse or seizure call 112/999. If your team has given you different local thresholds or emergency instructions, follow those instructions.

Scan to open your treatment portal

Regimen information only; this code contains no patient details.

<https://sactcheck.com/docs/patient/00857/>



[Official NCCP source](#) · SACTCheck v0.80.2 · Developed by Dr Paul O'Brien. Patient information prototype for clinical review; follow your oncology team's advice and local emergency instructions.